

Cycling activism: turning imagination into action

SDG Month – Telfer @ uOttawa

March 16 – 12:00 – 2:30pm

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10 reasons why cars are bad



A photograph of a traffic jam on a city street. Several cars are visible, with thick white exhaust smoke billowing from their tailpipes, filling the air. The scene is captured from a slightly elevated rear perspective, showing the backs of the cars in the queue. The background shows some trees and a building under a clear sky.

**1 - cars
poison the
air we
breathe**



**2 - cars kill
people**



**3 - cars waste
our time**

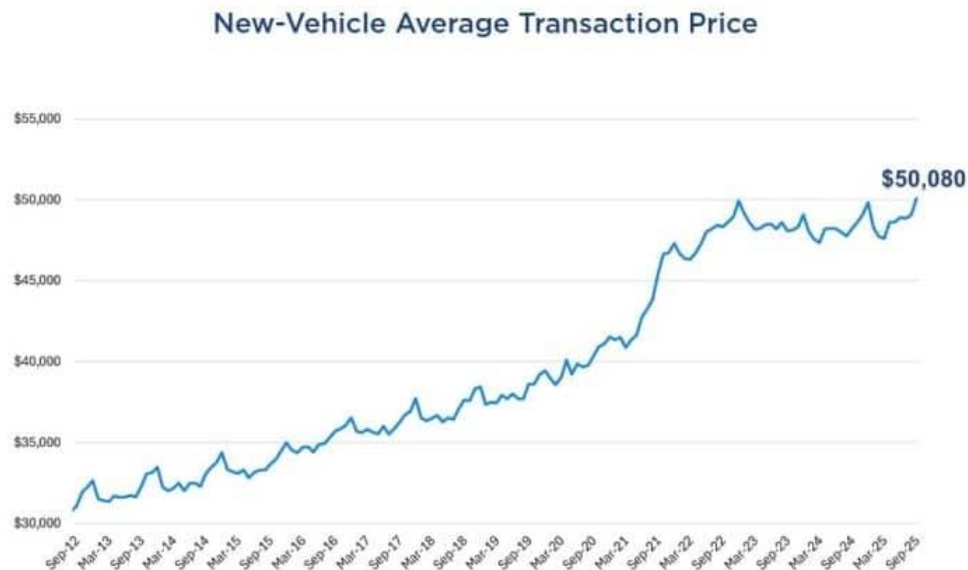
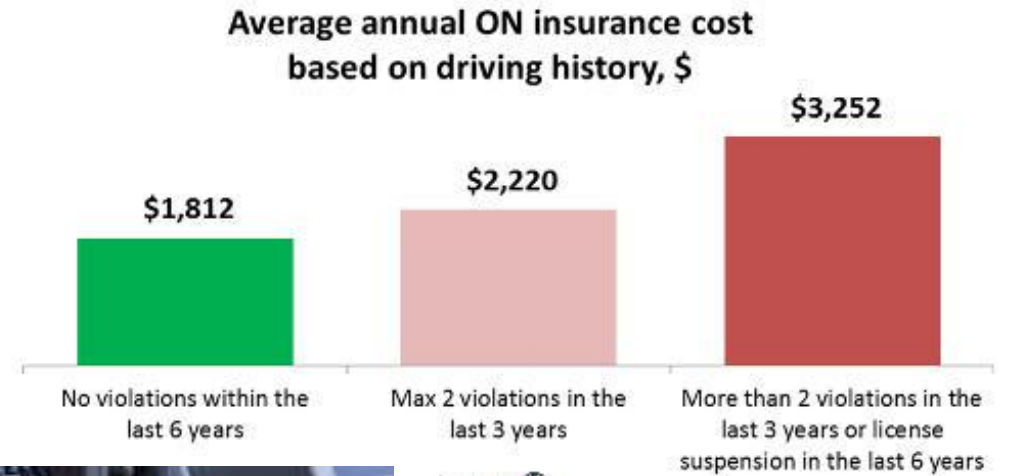
**4 - cars make
us stressed out
and angry**



**5 - Cars make
us sedentary**



6 - cars are costly to purchase, insure, fuel, maintain & repair



7 - cars erode community



An aerial photograph of a large, rectangular parking lot filled with hundreds of cars. The cars are parked in neat, diagonal rows, creating a strong sense of order and repetition. The colors of the cars vary, including red, blue, silver, black, and yellow. The parking lot is paved with dark asphalt, and white lines mark the individual parking spaces. In the center of the image, there is a black rectangular box with white text that reads "8 - cars waste public land".

**8 - cars waste
public land**

An aerial photograph of a city, likely Los Angeles, showing a major multi-lane highway (the 10 Freeway) running vertically through the center. The highway is flanked by dense urban development, including residential neighborhoods, commercial areas, and parking lots. The city extends far into the distance, illustrating the concept of urban sprawl. The sky is clear and blue.

9 - cars cause urban sprawl



**10 - car infrastructure costs a fortune...
which we pay for with out taxes**

**The solution to all these
problems? Cycling!**



**So how do we achieve
cycling mass adoption?**





Amsterdam

"In 1975, the traffic death rate in the Netherlands was 20 percent higher than in America, but by 2008 it was 60 percent lower."



Copenhagen

A large group of people, including men, women, and children, are riding bicycles on a city street in Copenhagen. They are wearing various types of clothing, including jackets, helmets, and scarves. The street is paved with asphalt and has a blue-painted crosswalk. In the background, there are trees and buildings.

“Things started to change in the midst of the 1970s oil crisis because Copenhageners were fed up and wanted to have their city back. At one point a third of the city population gathered in front of city hall to demand change, parents wanted to be able to send their kids to school on their own, and more generally Copenhageners wanted to have a city and not only transport and car space. [...]

At the same time, Copenhagen was very poor, as late as the early 1990s the city was on the brink of bankruptcy – so it had to invest in the cheapest possible infrastructure, which is bicycle infrastructure. They made it safe, easy, widespread, and slowly people really started using that mode of transportation as the easiest and fastest way to work, which was accelerated even further in the mid 2000s after a political shift at the mayoral level towards greener politics. Today 62% of Copenhageners use the bicycle every day to go to work and school, an unprecedented number.

Bogotá



On Sunday, 15 December 1974, a group of residents in Bogotá, Colombia, tried an experiment: they closed 5 kilometres of a major road in the city to cars for a few hours. Ciclovía, also known as Open Streets, was born. Since then it has become a reference, inspiring more than 400 cities to replicate similar programmes.

The concept is simple, though not easy to implement in car-centric cities: the temporary creation of more than 100 kilometres of car-free streets every Sunday and public holiday across a city with nearly 9 million inhabitants – 2 million of them come out to Ciclovía every week.

Montréal



We can't wait on our elected officials to do the right thing

“The Ontario government is taking another swing at municipal bike lanes. Doug Ford’s administration has announced new restrictions that would block the construction of any lanes requiring road reconfigurations, according to Cycle Toronto. [...] It marks the third time in a little more than a year that Minister of Transportation Prabmeet Sarkaria has amended the Highway Traffic Act to target bike lanes.”

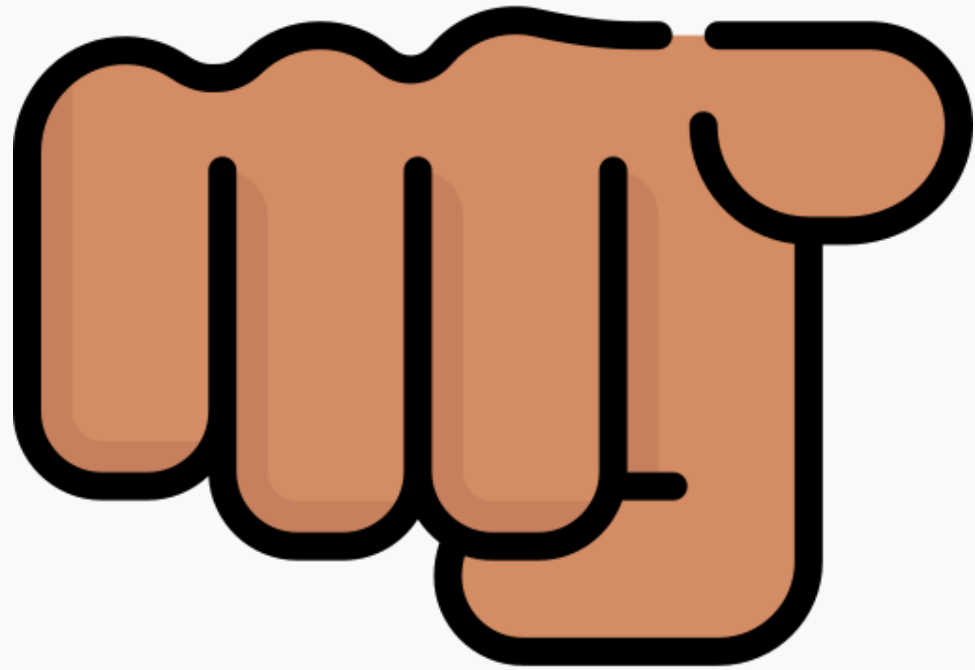


Let's look at people doing things right here to make it happen

- <https://bikeottawa.ca/>
- https://www.forourkids.ca/kidicalmass_ottawa
- <https://cyclingguide.org/download-the-cycling-guide-mobile-app/>
- <https://schoolstreetsottawa.ca/>
- <https://bikeminds.ca/>
- <https://ottawabikecafe.com/>
- <https://velocanadabikes.org/initiatives/bikedayonthehill/>
- <https://sharetheroad.ca/>



**Now, what can you do to turn
Ottawa into a cycling city?**



Expected time breakdown

Welcoming participants	20 min.
Opening presentation	20 min.
Research on people doing things	10 min.
Discussion on people doing things	10 min.
Research on what can you do (focus on one idea) - initiative - vision - implementation	30 min.
Presentations on what you can do	40 min.
Buffer time at the end	20 min.

	Initiative	Vision	Implementation